IMPERIAL GAZETTEER OF INDIA - ARCHAEOLOGICAL SURVEYS
BELLARY DISTRICT AND THE RUINS OF VIJAYANAGARA (HAMPI)

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Geographical Coordinates: 15.3350 N, 76.4600 E
Historical Period: Vijayanagara Empire (1336 - 1565 CE)

I. TOPOGRAPHY AND MEDIEVAL SETTLEMENT
The monumental ruins of Vijayanagara, modern-day Hampi, span across an area of twenty-six square kilometres

Founded in 1336 CE by the Sangama brothers Harihara I and Bukka Raya I, Hampi functioned as the fortified m

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II. HYDRAULIC INFRASTRUCTURE AND URBAN WATERWAYS
The survival of an urban population exceeding 500,000 citizens in an arid Deccan landscape depended on monu

The engineers constructed stone anicuts (weirs) across the turbulent Tungabhadra River, diverting torrents into r

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III. THE VITTALA TEMPLE AND MUSICAL PILLARS
The Vittala temple complex represents the absolute high-water mark of Vijayanagara architectural artistry, initiate

The Mahamandapa comprises fifty-six composite granite pillars, each carved from a single monolith into clusters